

25STCV26114 25STCV26114

County: los-angeles

Division: Civil Law and Motion

Department: 517

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Case Number: 25STCV26114 Hearing Date: September 24, 2026 Dept: 517

The Court is granting the Defendants' petition to confirm the arbitration award entered in their favor and against Plaintiff Michelle Ritter by Retired Judge Beth Andrus. The Court is denying Ritter's petition to vacate the award. Ritter's challenges to the factual bases for the award are beyond the scope of this Court's permitted review of an arbitration award. Ritter argues that the parties' arbitration agreement permits the Court to review the award for errors of law. The Court sees no legal error in the award. Equally unavailing are Ritter's challenges to the award under Code of Civil Procedure section 1286.2, subdivisions (a)(3), (a)(4), and (a)(5). Ritter has failed to demonstrate how any of those provisions applies here to overcome the arbitration award.

The Court is sustaining the Defendants' objections to the evidence that Ritter submitted in opposition to the Defendants' petition to confirm the award and her petition to vacate it. Ritter withheld this evidence in the arbitration. She thus cannot present it to this Court.

Ritter disregarded this Court's order granting Ritter authority to file an oversized, combined opposition to the Defendants' petition to confirm the award and a petition to vacate the award. Specifically, Ritter filed both an opposition to Defendants' petition and her own petition. Together, they are about double the size of the combined brief the Court authorized. The Court nevertheless read the entirety of Ritter's submission and did not stop reading after the page limit was exceeded. That said, Ritter's disregard of the Court's order is of a piece with her disregard of Judge Andrus's orders in the arbitration that led Judge Andrus to hold Ritter in default and to conduct a prove-up hearing at which the Defendants presented their case for entry of an arbitration award in their favor both in writing and orally. (Judge Andrus permitted Ritter to participate in that hearing, and Ritter did participate.)

The Court will enter the proposed order that the Defendants submitted with their petition. The Court directs counsel for Defendants to submit a revised proposed judgment that memorializes the order. Upon entry of the judgment, the Court will dismiss Ritter's action against the Defendants.